

3D-Printed Ducted-Fan Quadcopter

I designed the airframe in CAD, 3D-printed the main structure, assembled the physical prototype, and designed a custom STM32 flight-controller PCB for the same platform.

ALL FILES : [GitHub Repository](#)



WHAT THIS PROJECT SHOWS

- Mechanical CAD for a Modular ducted-fan quadcopter frame.
- 3D-printed parts assembled into a physical prototype.
- Custom KiCad flight-controller PCB from ground up.
- Shows a complete hardware development workflow from design to testing.

CURRENT STATUS

Mechanical prototype built. Custom PCB designed. Next step is board fabrication, bring-up, firmware, and controlled flight testing.

SECTIONS

CAD / Mechanical Design

Fusion 360 model, engineering drawing, and main geometry.

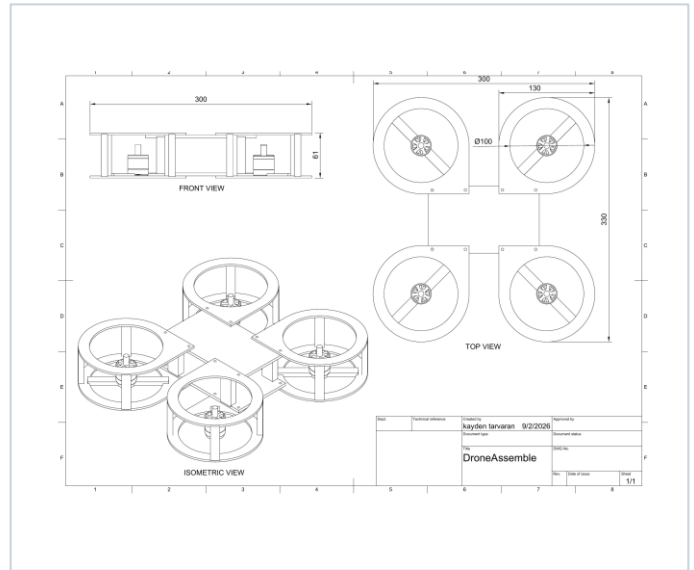
3D-Printed Assembly

Printed and tested components, hardware fitment, and motor integration.

Custom PCB

STM32F4 controller board, sensors, power management, and I/O.

Airframe CAD and Assembly Drawing



MAIN DIMENSIONS

300 mm

OVERALL WIDTH

330 mm

OVERALL LENGTH

61 mm

OVERALL HEIGHT

Ø100 mm

DUCT OPENING

DESIGN NOTES

The frame uses four ducted propeller modules connected to a central body.

The frame was designed to support stability and navigation testing by using four 2300KV brushless motors connected to 10cm dual blade propellers. A strong focus was placed on modular design to make the system easy to manufacture, modify, and upgrade.

TOOLS USED

Fusion 360 for 3D modeling and technical drawings, Ulti maker Cura for slicing and G-code generation, and an Ender 3 for 3D printing.

From Printed Parts to Prototype



LEFT: PART LAYOUT

The printed parts were laid out before assembly to check that the ducts, plates, supports, and motor modules matched the CAD plan.



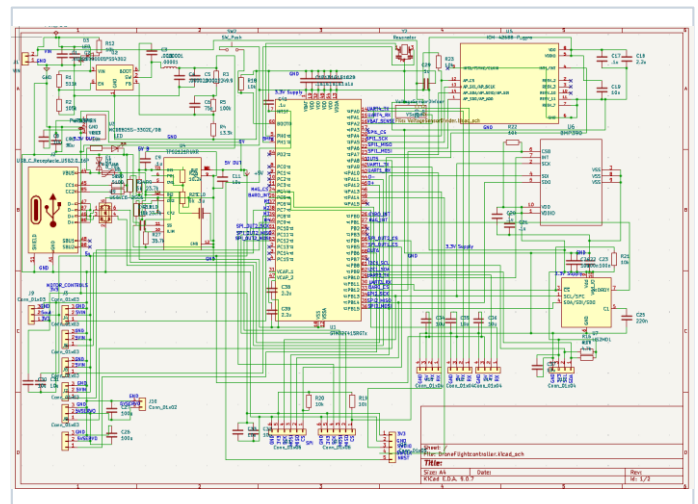
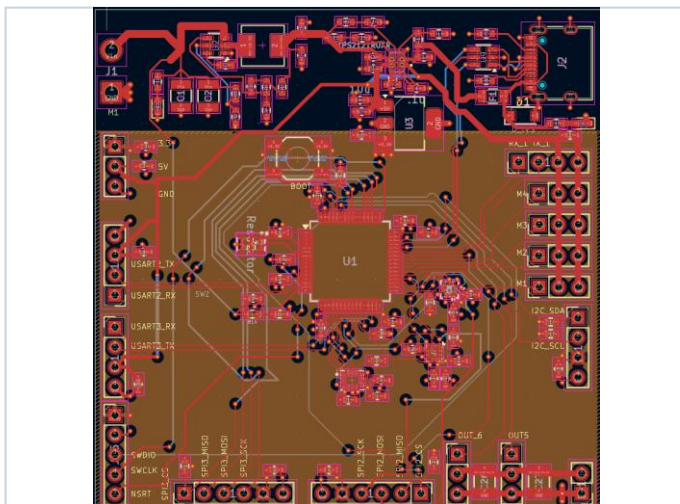
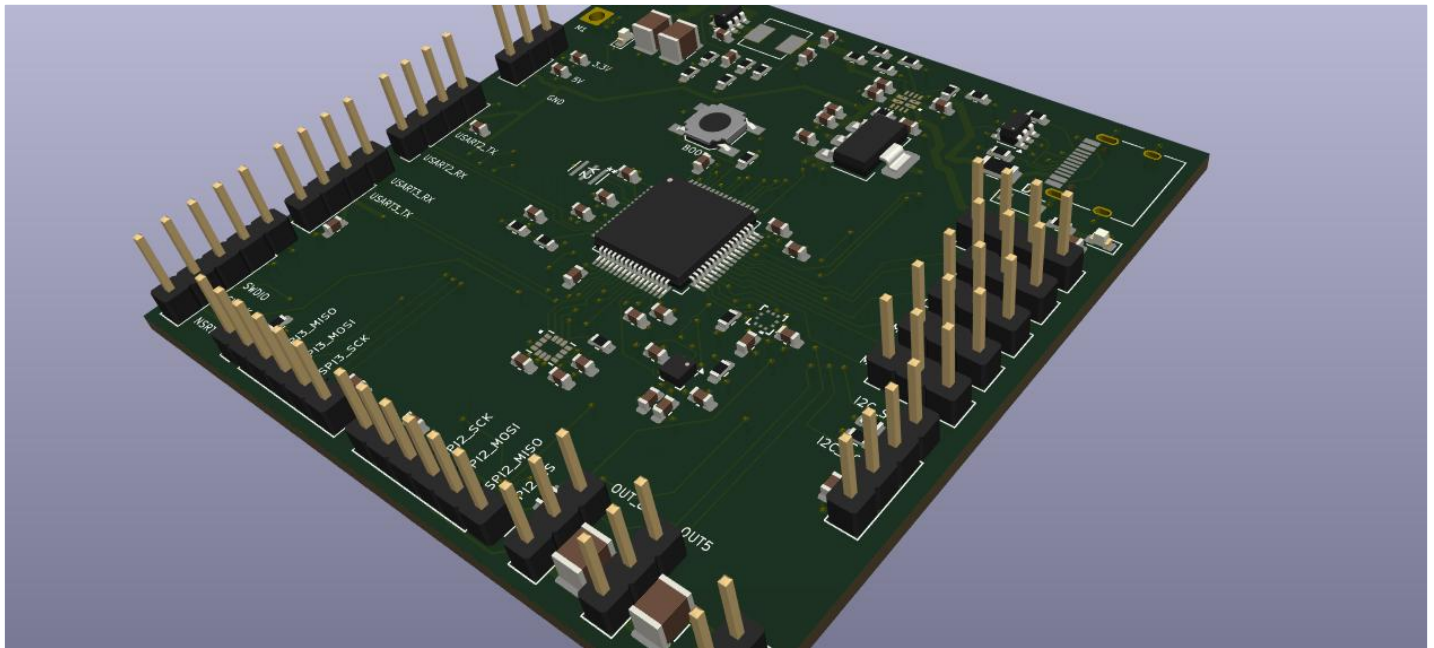
RIGHT: ASSEMBLED FRAME

The duct assembly was screwed to the main body, while the pillars were glued in place to secure the structure.

WHAT I LEARNED FROM THIS BUILD

Design choices were driven by the manufacturing process. Using a basic 3D printer required the frame to be split into smaller, more printable parts to improve reliability and simplify reprints.

Custom STM32 Flight-Controller PCB



BOARD CHOICES

- STM32F415RGT6 MCU as the main controller.
- ICM-42688-P gyro/IMU, BMP390 barometer, and LIS2MDL magnetometer.
- 5 V buck regulator, 3.3 V LDO rail, and USB-C / battery power path.
- SPI, I²C, UART, PWM motor outputs, SWD programming, and external I/O headers.

NEXT REVISION / FUTURE WORK

Order and assemble the PCB, Configure onboard sensor telemetry and functionality, develop firmware, incorporate external sensors for autonomous / Intelligent navigation.